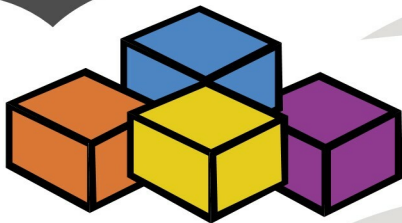


VBA Macro Interoperability in OpenOffice.org



This article explains VBA support in OpenOffice.org, including the build process of Go-oo.

The ABC Auditing Company decides to migrate to OpenOffice.org. The firm gets a copy of OOo installed on every machine and trains its employees to work with documents in ODF (Open Document Format), as well as with older documents that were prepared in the MS Office format, in OOo. Everything seems to be going smoothly.

Suddenly, however, it's noted that a few important Excel (spreadsheet) documents with macros are not functioning properly in OOo. They may need a developer to rewrite VBA code in OOBASIC. This may take some time and money, as going back to the old environment is not an option any longer. The manager now wishes he had a copy of

OOo that could handle VBA also. Thankfully, this is not a dream and is possible with some versions of OOo that support VBA. ABC Auditing should have chosen the right version when it decided to migrate to OOo.

VBA macros

Visual Basic for Applications (VBA) is an implementation of Microsoft's Visual Basic integrated into Microsoft Office applications. You may wonder about the need for such a discussion in a FOSS article. Well, many organisations are migrating to OOo nowadays, but a lot of their old documents are in the MS Office format. When an MS Office document is opened in OOo, the VBA macros present in them are unusable under most circumstances. So VBA macros have to